WONDER DAILY

How Holograms Work

A bird inside a card

A flat shiny square holds a tiny bird. Tilt the card, and you can see around its sides.

Two ripples cross

Two ripple rings cross in a pan. Bumps stack up, and a bump plus a dip cancels to calm.

Stripes, not a picture

A laser beam splits in two. Where the beams cross on the film, it records stripes, not a picture.

Two halves, both whole

Break a hologram in half. Each half still shows the whole shell, because every spot saw it all.

A rainbow bird

The bird is not painted. Tiny grooves bend light back into the bird, so each eye sees it a new way.

A bird that floats?

Most floating stage pictures are a reflection in slanted glass. Could light ever draw in empty air?

Make a little book

1 Fold it into 8 boxes. Open it flat.

2 Fold short end to short end. Cut the thick line. Open it.

3 Fold the long way, pictures out. Push the ends in.

4 Fold into a book. Page 1 goes on the front!